

Read. Learn. Speak

By

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Reading Report: “Lessons on Anglo-Indian food and culture at 1882 Alfresco”

Link : <https://www.thehindu.com/food/dining/lessons-on-anglo-indian-food-and-culture-at-1882-alfresco-a-new-restaurant-in-bengaluru/article70235699.ece>

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1. Vocabulary Learnt (with English Dictionary Definitions)

While reading the article, I noted several rich and contextually meaningful words. Here are five key vocabulary words I learned or reinforced, along with their Oxford English Dictionary (OED)-style definitions:

Pastoral	Relating to the countryside, especially in a peaceful or idealized way; often associated with shepherds or rural simplicity.
Regale	To entertain or amuse (someone) with talk, stories, or food.
Piquant	Having a pleasantly sharp or spicy taste; also, something that is stimulating.
Succulent	tender, juicy, and tasty; full of interest or appeal.
Homage	A public display of respect or admiration for someone or something, often through art, actions, or tribute.

2. Key Insights from the Article

- Food carries history: The dishes at 1882 Alfresco aren’t just meals—they’re stories of cultural mixing between British and Indian traditions during the colonial era.
- Whitefield has a forgotten past: Before it became Bengaluru’s IT hub, Whitefield was a settlement for Anglo-Indians—a fact many locals (including me!) didn’t know.
- Culinary preservation matters: By reviving dishes like “bubble and squeak” or “bad word curry,” the restaurant helps protect a fading cultural identity.

- Language in food is playful: The use of terms like “bad word curry” shows how communities use humor and secrecy to navigate social norms.
 - Context shapes cuisine: Indo-Chinese food (like chilli tofu) emerged because of migration during British rule—proving that food evolves with history.
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3. How I Plan to Use These New Words

I will incorporate these words thoughtfully—not just to sound “fancy,” but to express ideas more precisely:

- In creative writing: Instead of saying “the village looked calm,” I might write, “the scene was beautifully *pastoral*.”
- In presentations or essays: When describing how someone shares stories passionately, I can say they “*regaled* the audience with tales of heritage.”
- In food reviews (even informal ones): I’ll describe a spicy, tangy chutney as “delightfully *piquant*” instead of just “spicy.”
- When praising art, film, or food that honors a tradition, I’ll say it’s a “loving *homage* to...”
- For describing rich, flavorful dishes (like biryani or slow-cooked curries), I’ll use “*succulent*” to convey juiciness and depth.

By using these words in real contexts—school projects, conversations, or even social media captions—I aim to internalize them naturally, not just memorize them.

Reflection

Reading *The Hindu*’s food and culture pieces doesn’t just teach me about recipes—it opens windows into India’s layered past. And every new word I learn is a tool to understand and share those stories better.

Thank You Note (Using Vocabulary from the Article)

Thank you for your invaluable guidance in refining my communication. Your mentorship is a true homage to thoughtful expression. You’ve helped me embrace piquant vocabulary and craft succulent, vivid writing. You regale us not just with lessons, but with culture and care, turning every session into something meaningful. Understanding pastoral histories or complex ideas feels richer because of you. I’m deeply grateful for your belief in my voice and your patience in shaping it.